

Stefano Zurita

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EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Business Economics Wilfrid Laurier University (Waterloo, Canada)	2026
Master of Information Systems (Business Intelligence & Data Analytics) Universidad Internacional del Ecuador (Quito, Ecuador) / Escuela Internacional de Gerencia (Granada, Spain)	2024
Bachelor's Degree in Economics Universidad San Francisco de Quito (Quito, Ecuador)	2021

EXPERIENCE

Budget Analyst (Economist), Finance – Budget Coordination Team <i>Regional Municipality of York, Newmarket, Ontario, Canada</i>	May 2026 – Present
- Contribute to the preparation of York Region's multi-year Budget Book, supporting the transition from departmental to service-based budgeting across a four-year horizon. - Lead the consolidation of service-level KPIs, translating operational performance measures into financial inputs for Council reporting. - Manage TM1 (Planning Analytics) rollups and alternative hierarchies to align reporting structures with the new service-based framework. - Review business cases, RFP-related financial inputs, and funding requests across client departments. - Reconcile financial data across PeopleSoft and TM1 to produce reports and dashboards used in budget reviews.	
Economist (Co-op), Finance – Budget Coordination Team <i>Regional Municipality of York, Newmarket, Ontario, Canada</i>	May 2025 – December 2025
- Supported the preparation of York Region's 2026 annual Budget Book by consolidating departmental inputs and reconciling figures across PeopleSoft and TM1. - Performed variance and trend analysis to identify operational risks and support KPI tracking. - Documented and mapped over 700 TM1-based reports to strengthen data governance during an ERP transition.	
Finance Planning Supervisor <i>Public Mobility and Infrastructure Company, Quito, Ecuador</i>	2022 – 2024
- Promoted from Planning Analyst to Planning Supervisor for effectively managing the Annual Plan and optimizing resource allocation between departments. - Developed and implemented data-driven dashboards using Power BI and Excel to support key strategic initiatives, including market trend analysis and performance optimization. - Conducted secondary research to identify operational improvement opportunities and supported executive-level reports with data-driven insights. - Designed automated systems to track and issue certifications, reducing manual errors by 20% and streamlining inventory management.	
Insurance Sales Intern <i>Pelotea Inc., Quito, Ecuador</i>	April 2021 – December 2021
- Processed client transactions in HubSpot CRM and supported accounts receivable follow-up to ensure timely payments and accurate records. - Resolved order-related issues and customer inquiries in coordination with the sales team.	

SELECTED PROJECTS (ECONOMETRICS & DATA SCIENCE)

Master's research Project – Criminal Involvement and Health Insurance Coverage Among Serious Youth Offenders <i>Ordinary Least Squares & Fixed-Effects in Stata</i> Estimated the crime–insurance link using the Pathways to Desistance dataset; –6pp OLS association disappears under fixed effects.
Master's Thesis (Business Intelligence) – Pattern & Anomaly Detection <i>Unsupervised learning on national economic & social data</i> Identified unusual patterns in Ecuador's 2013–2023 datasets to support risk reviews; reproducible and documented.
Insurance Fraud Detection (toy, synthetic) <i>Python ML: Logistic, Random Forest, Gradient Boosting</i> Fraud-detection pipeline on 20k synthetic auto claims; optimized profit and explained drivers.
Singapore CPI Forecasting (2010–2024) <i>Python & Stata: LASSO, ARIMA, Random Walk</i> Rolling CPI forecasts for Singapore; LASSO delivered the lowest error.

Automobile Markets Research

Econometrics: demand estimation, price elasticity, competition

U.S. auto demand analysis; elasticities & competitive effects to inform pricing/assortment.

Visualizations (Power BI, Kepler.gl)

Dashboards & geospatial analysis

Executive KPI dashboards and urban-infrastructure hotspot mapping for decision support.

CORE SKILLS

Budgeting & Financial Analysis: Operating and capital budgeting, forecasting, variance and trend analysis, scenario modeling, financial reporting.

Economic & Quantitative Analysis: Econometrics (OLS, fixed effects), cost-benefit analysis, KPI design, risk identification.

ERP & Systems: PeopleSoft, TM1 / Planning Analytics, data reconciliation, master data validation, ERP migration support.

Process Improvement & Automation: Workflow optimization, Excel macros, SQL-based reconciliation, internal controls, cycle-time reduction.

Technical Tools: Excel (Advanced), SQL, Python, Power BI, Stata, PowerPoint.

Languages:  English (Fluent)  Spanish (Native)